Upon A Midnight

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Teen And Up Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Frosta/Oc

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Frosta (She-Ra), Original Female Character(s)

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Fluff, Love Confessions, Teenagers, Norway (Country), Norwaydora, Sneaking Out, Holding Hands, Knife Squad, Side Story, First Kiss

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Upon A Midnight

by Lisra

Summary

One evening Maia finds a note from her friend Frosta on her window.

A side story from the Norwaydora AU featuring Frosta and Maia, two members of the Knife Squad posse of young teens.

Notes

Thanks go to Lyssandia for inspiring this little fic and for beta'ing it to boot!

If you have not, please consider reading my longfic Polar Night/Midnight Sun to get the full context for these two characters. It's also my favorite work. :D

See the end of the work for more notes

Maia's heart flutters a little when she spots the piece of paper hiding under a stone on her windowsill. The old folks were right: some things did not hit the same with a cellphone. She walks over and opens the window, careful not to damage the insect netting. It's a small index card like the ones her mother had used to practise sámi with her. It reads:

"*Fjøsa, midnatt. -F"*

Maia's breath catches for a moment as her mind runs through a list of facts. She's already dressed down for bed. But Frosta wouldn't just ask to meet her in the old barn at midnight on a whim. There'd have to be something. Or she was just *really* bored. It's the polar summer so it will be light and she can go directly across the fields but she might also be seen. She glances at the clock on her bedside table.

It's late so she has to decide *now*.

She is halfway into her hoodie before she realizes she's moving already. Maybe she has got a crush. She struggles into it and grabs some sweatpants from the mountain of clothes on her floor and kicks the stupid bra deeper into it. Her sneakers are downstairs but she has an extra pair of shoes stashed in her wardrobe for this very eventuality. A shame about the netting, but that can't be helped. A minute later,with the netting now sporting a rather larger hole, Maia is standing outside, pulling her window closed with a piece of string tied to a nail in the frame. Then she stands pressed against the wall and waits for ten long breaths. Everything in the valley is quiet, even the cows. She turns and jumps over the fence, runs across a little path and vanishes into the field that leads to the small stream. She feels a spike of adrenaline, as if there was a chance of someone yelling after her. But you never knew who was out and about to see the midnight sun. She had seen a neighbour paint their house at 1am just "because it was light and I had the time". Her legs propel her over a low wall between fields, way more smoothly than expected. Something, a familiar pressure against her thigh is missing and

her hand touches only cloth. She realizes she has forgotten her knife. It's on her desk, all clean, shiny and *not with her*. Maia feels altogether underdressed without it.

The Hauan house is dark and quiet in the distance. She sees the car is there, so everyone is probably in bed. She circles the house along the stream where the grass grows highest and the gentle gurgles help to mask her steps. A slight wind brings in the scents of the countryside. Maia approaches the barn from the far side. The side towards the house has an artificial hill leading to a short wooden bridge so ease access to the first floor. It will be locked, of course, but she knows where there's a loose slat and a gap she can squeeze into. She hopes she will not outgrow it anytime soon.

Inside it's dark and the smell is pronounced, even though the Hauans haven't had livestock for ages. The boxes that formerly held cows are now used to store a variety of farm equipment and junk. Maia waits for her eyes to adjust to the gloom and creeps forward, step by step, eyes to the floor and arms stretched out. There's no telling what she might stumble over if she's not careful. It takes several minutes and her heart is hammering by the time she reaches the deep end of the barn. The hatch is so far above her that she can only just reach it. There are many long nails hammered into the wall however. They had spent hours doing that and so she can wedge one foot onto the nails and just about grab the opening above. She takes a deep breath and jumps and pulls at the same time. It's not enough. Maia barely manages not to scream. Her other foot is now up against the wall as well, but her arms are straining. She is stuck.

There's a creak above her and a hand touches her arm. Warmth spreads out from where it touches her. She wishes she wasn't wearing long sleeves.

"Need a hand?" Frosta sounds amused.

"Faen, yes," Maia hisses and with Frosta's help she struggles up to the second floor. She feels the hand lingering on her arm for a moment. She bites her lip. They are both breathing heavily. Frosta

lets go of Maia’s arm and steps back and she misses the touch the moment it disappears. The dim light conceals her blush and she’s grateful for that. Her hoodie feels too warm all of a sudden. *Okay, so I got a crush. Maybe. A little bit.*

The second floor runs the entire length of the barn but there are sheer drops at the sides to let people look down into the cattle boxes. On the far side there’s a wooden ladder leading up to the third level. An opening high up on the wall behind them lets in some light from outside. This is their domain. Frosta’s older siblings have done some work on it before but it really had been both them and their friend Øyvind that had turned this floor into a playground. There’s a normal swing, a swing made out of a huge log and one that’s basically a trapeze, all suspended from the ceiling with nylon ropes and the same huge nails that assisted the passage upwards. There’s old furniture from the house arranged in a children’s fancy of a living room. The cupboards contain the Knife Squad’s collected treasures.

A moment later that’s where Maia and Frosta are, sitting on an old leather sofa in the pale glow of a camping cube that gives enough light to help them see one another's faces but not enough to be noticeable from the outside.

Maia looks at her friend in the soft glow. She wonders when doing so started to make her heart beat faster, fingers hot and twitchy, her skin all tingly like it wants to shed and run away. It just happened one day; snuck up on her, like periods and growing boobs and pubic hair. It makes standing next to her at work difficult sometimes. It helps how often they were elbow deep in fish guts. Focuses the mind. But now her mind is all focused on the shadowy halo of Frosta’s hair that makes her look, to her eyes, like a pale night princess. But there’s also the little lines that show when Frosta laughs, her slashed eyebrows that make her face so expressive and her eyes shine when she throws her glare around a room. No one has ever called it beautiful. It is *intense.* But Maia has, in the privacy of her own mind, whenever she is done counting the cute freckles.

“So, uh, what’s up?” She asks, breaking the long silence. Her friend doesn’t answer. She looks away instead, fidgeting with her hands. Maia’s brow furrows.

“Did something happen? Is that why you didn’t send a text?”

Usually Frosta happened to other people, but nothing was impossible. A tiny ember of worry begins to glow inside Maia. But her friend doesn’t look upset or hurt. She looks… nervous, maybe? It’s hard to read her face in the pale yellow light.

Frosta inches closer. Maia swallows and forces herself to look at her. Maia fervently hopes her friend can’t see her blush, or sense the heat radiating from her face like a signal flare. They have been like this many times when talking about stuff. Lately though Maia kept having thoughts of just leaning forward and kissing her. She never did, obviously. But it’s so tempting. They have always talked about everything. But never about that. Any stuff like that even. It had just not been a part of their world until one day they were suddenly teenagers and it was but Maia never dared to ask Frosta if she had a crush or, oh god, if she thought she might like other girls. That also had just happened one day when she had looked at another girl and thought *she’s so pretty* for the first time in a way she never had before. Maybe that was what growing up was, things sneaking up on you and suddenly being the new normal, like hair on your legs. There weren't many children her age. Most were too young or too old and may as well have occupied a different planet, even in tiny Eltoft school. Romance was something that happened in books right up until it stared you in the face. Or smiled at you from the other side of a barrel of dead fish.

“I have to tell you something,” Frosta says ominously, nervously, staring right at her in the way she sometimes does, unblinking and open. The ember of worry flickered again.

“I..I…” Frosta tries and stutters, perhaps for the first time in her life.

“What?” she prompts.

Frosta’s eyes widen and *there* is the bravery she knows so well flaming up behind her friend’s eyes. Her entire posture shifts, like it always does when she decides to be bold. Maia has always admired it. It’s her most becoming trait.

They are even closer now. Maia could just lean forward and their noses would touch and their lips could brush and she could take her right hand and wrap it…

“I... Maia. I think I got a crush on you,” Frosta blurts out, too loud for the proximity and the late hour. She stares at her with wide eyes, breathing hard. Maia feels it on her face.

“Sorry,” Frosta adds, more quietly.

Maia blinks. She has never felt so aware of a moment in her young life. She feels herself, how her body sits, pushing down on the sofa, how the light plays off Frosta’s face and her shining eyes, how the gentle wind outside moves the grass and creaks the timbers, how the stream gurgles in the distance and how the insects chirp and the sea rumbles in the distance. The earth rushes through space, turning on her axis and she is here, in this moment, turning with it and turning around in her head what she just heard.

Her face splits into a grin and she makes a choking sound as the words she wants to say stumble into one another and get stuck on their way out. So instead she decides to let actions speak louder than the words she can’t get out and simply takes Frosta’s hand. Her friend’s face relaxes, but her body remains tense.

“That’s good,” Maia muses, grinning as realization spreads through her like a bath bomb through water, “because so do I. On you, I mean -”

Maia doesn’t manage to finish her sentence, because Frosta is kissing her. She is so close, so close their bodies are touching awkwardly in this twisted position on the sofa but none of that

matters. Frosta is kissing her and Maia's arms wrap around Frosta and then she's kissing back, clumsily, wet and with nervous excitement shaking both of them.

It's a perfect moment.

It lasts forever and a minute until they need to breathe and lean back. Their faces are red, they feel hot and Maia's thoughts are buzzing.

"Wow, so…wow," she muses. Frosta is laughing to herself and wipes her face with her hands. Maia understands. Maybe she would be crying happy tears as well if she had actually thought to confess. To dare.

"You sound like Adora."

Maia snorts.

"You'd sound stupid too if the girl you were crushing on says out of the blue she's crushing on you, alright?"

"Fair," Frosta concedes. They look at one another, grinning, beaming. *This is real!*

"Can you imagine her dumb face when she sees us, like, holding hands?" She pictures how Adora would not know where to look and probably blush and run away.

"Yeah. She'll be like a beet and then run off to untwist a line or something before coming back." Frosta raises her hands and makes flapping motions.

"*Could you please, like, do this when we're not working, or when I'm not looking? I mean, uh, congrats I guess? Kids these days!* And then she'll run off to text Catra. Bet?"

Maia laughs at the thought. They both love Adora and her girlfriend Catra. They are like older sisters, mentors, confidants. They are also gigantic dorks and losers, like all grown ups. She

smiles and looks at the other girl. Her girl. *Girlfriend. Girl. Hers.* She chuckles and looks away for a moment.

"We are going to be so *bad* at this," Maia whispers. Frosta giggles and her arm wraps around Maia's waist.

"At what?" She asks. If there was enough light Maia could see the cute freckles on her face. She likes how dark Frosta's eyes look. It makes her look dark and mysterious, even though she is grinning and shaking slightly with excitement.

"Girfriend stuff," Maia answers vaguely, losing herself in the moment. She feels so full of life, like she could burst out of her skin at any moment or that all this energy, all this joy would explode out of her like some sort of super hero energy. *I've got a girlfriend.* Will she ever be able to wrap her head around this? What does that even *mean? But Catra and Adora figured it out and they had been brain hurtingly stupid about it -*

Maia's breath hitches when she feels a handslide up to the side of her neck. Fingers twine into her hair. All the thoughts that had risen like a mental house of cards collapse and she's back in the moment, centimeters away from her best friend, the girl who confessed her crush to her, her actual *gyrimala faen girlfriend*. She can feel Frosta's breath on her own face. Maia's hand finds Frosta's. It feels just as warm as her own.

"We just have to practise," Frosta whispers and Maia grins back. Their lips meet again, more confidently this time.

They have a lot to talk about, but for now they are content with kissing and holding one another. Talking can wait.

End Notes

Thank you for reading. I hope you enjoyed this little side show. This came about as I was writing a as of nov 25 unreleased fic and Lyssa promted me to think about the relationship of Maia and Frosta. If people are interested there could be a follow up which dives deeper into their history, their families etc,.

Tusen takk!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!